GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

February 27th, 2026
Week 9
Volume 281, Issue 1225

Highlights:

- **On edge.**
- **Shipping halt.**
- **Oil flies?**
- **Recycling deprived.**
- **Disruption.**

- **Scan to download / view the Weekly on the GMS App!**

QUOTE of the WEEK

"Words of encouragement during a failure are worth more than an hour of praise after success"

– Unknown

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

Click "Ctrl" + below to launch the GMS Weekly Summary Podcast

W.A.R.

Whackos Attacking Reality — WAR — is literally the definition of the weekend as the Middle East descended into all-out chaos between the U.S. & Israel on one side and Iran on the other, leaving regional and international markets bracing for the inevitable whirlpool of global insanity that is about to suck the entire world into short-term (at the very least) tumult.

Oil was already on its way up during the week, but as the weekend came around, it spiked over 10%, jumping from around USD 63/barrel last week to nearly USD 71.90/barrel at the time of writing. The Baltic Exchange was also on its way up (rising 1.1%) but remained comparatively subdued in comparison to oil futures…yet. The Cape, Panamax, and Supra indices all climbed 0.2%, 1.4%, and 3% respectively. Currencies, too, took a hammering, as all of the major ship recycling destinations registered declines across the board. Local steel plate prices also declined across the board, albeit marginally, likely waiting for Monday to turn around before deciding whether to join the ranks of rising rates.

The news immediately worsens for the maritime industry as insurance premiums, bunkers, voyage insurance, blockages, delays, and charters running afoul are just the tip of this ballooning iceberg while the dust settles amid a still inexplicable war campaign that is reportedly set to continue for at least another four weeks — which clearly means buckle up, folks.

Especially as calls for calm and de-escalation intensify but are reportedly falling on deaf ears on the Iranian side following the assassination of Iran's Supreme Leader in his compound and over 60 others, including children at a local school, according to U.S. sources.

The resulting backlash and retaliation from the pariah state have seen several major Middle Eastern states (Qatar, UAE (Dubai, Abu Dhabi), Oman and many more) come under direct Iranian fire across much of the last 36 hours. Iran has also reportedly halted shipping through the Strait of Hormuz, while the cancellation of thousands of regional and international flights to and from the region is another immediate knock-on effect to trade and commerce — not only in the region, but globally — as the rest of us wait with bated breath to see how the coming week unfolds.

As such, ship recycling activity, being so close to the action, has taken a back seat for now, as markets stall in anticipation of further drama and a lack of sales once again filters through to recycling markets that have already been deprived of tonnage due to recurring geopolitical setbacks. Not since the days of COVID have we seen such a significant disruption affect a single region so directly, with ripple effects spreading across the globe as the world wakes up to Monday and another conflict, with the next steps likely to reshape global politics and affect markets once again to a significant and unpredictable degree.

GMS market rankings / pricing for week 9 of 2026 are on Page 6.

BANGLADESH

Disparate!

Atop.

Bangladesh sits atop the Indian sub-continent ship recycling rankings for yet another week, amid fresh sales that have been hard to come by as trading markets endure another week of poking volatility that is continuing to deprive recycling markets of any meaningful tonnage.

The situation unfolding across the Middle East will be the chief focus of the world in the weeks ahead, and it is nearly assured that rising freight and oil rates will, in turn, see recycling markets forcibly face another spell of tonnage absence at the local waterfront, spelling trouble for the recyclers who are yet to receive their share of recompensate for all the yard expenses ensured during the HKC upgrade and accreditations phases.

Chief focus.

Speaking of tonnage absence at the bidding tables, all anchorages still have units arriving across the various locations, including Chattogram, which saw the arrival of a near 20K LDT bulker and a handful of smaller dry units, all while last week's large LDT LNG was delivered to her new owners for recycling. But with a major conflict now underway and Far Eastern markets still in a holiday mood, the coming weeks are likely to be a pinching affair for this market.

Fundamentals, meanwhile, have taken hits to varying degrees, as not only did local steel plate prices slide a couple of dollars to end the week at USD 507.81/ton, but the Taka also lost 0.20% and wound the week down at BDT 122.71 against the U.S. Dollar.

Newly elected.

Despite the globally brewing chaos, things domestically seem to be in a better state for the nation, as optimism lingers in the air on the back of the newly elected governing body in Bangladesh. They certainly have a job on their hands, deciphering where they sit on the international spectrum and with whom to form strategic alliances in this fractured and disparate world we now live in.

Tough March.

As tonnage at the bidding tables dries up once again and Far Eastern owners are still not fully back in business after the Chinese New Year holidays, Chattogram Choppers at least have a month of fasting and celebrations to keep them busy.

Tough March ahead.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

STALLED SUCCESSFULLY!

Fair share.

As the lowest-placed sub-continent market, India has been — and continues to — face hardships in the current environment, having to make do with strictly Alang-only HKC vessels in recent times, along with the usual distribution of specialist units such as LNGs, reefers, and offshore vessels. Local port positions indeed show that all sub-continent recycling destinations have had their fair share of arrivals in recent times, including this week, with India taking the largest slice of the sub-continent anchorage pie.

Conundrum.

And the irony? Despite being the lowest-placed ship recycling destination in the sub-continent, Alang recyclers were busy taking in nearly three times the number of vessels as their Chattogram counterparts / 1.5 times the LDT, but they took in nearly four times the number / about 20 times the LDT of the Gadani Gang. A juicy near-30K LDT LNG, a +25K LDT container was mixed in with a bevy of small LDT reefers, bulkers, and general cargo units that rounded off the arrivals list.

Slim pickings.

And through it all, even with the lowest prices on show, geography was busy baking its cookies on the shores of Western India, where Alang had been stalled on pricing but still managed to successfully beat out the competition on acquisitions and arrivals this week. Moreover, India's stance on the global stage will once again face scrutiny amid the latest Middle East madness, as was the case when it previously remained a neutral party between Russia and the West — a move that saw an enraged Trump levy the most tariffs against India in the sub-continent.

Hell or high water.

The real kicker remains the state of local fundamentals, which have left India stranded in third and facing many of the same hurdles competing markets faced this week — namely, marginally declining local steel plate prices that fell about USD 1/ton and closed the week at USD 400/ton, while the Indian Rupee aimlessly followed suit, slipping 0.31% and wrapping up the week at a high Rs. 91.02 once again.

Overall, and as previously stated, come hell or high water, Alang's torches always seem to have power.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

INCOMING ALERT!

Deprived.

While Pakistan has been alert to any available larger LDT dry vessels coming its way over the last few months, elevated freight markets continue to perform, keeping global ship recycling starved of any significant tonnage — a trend that has persisted for several years now. Despite holding the top spot for a short while and delivering Aliaga-like bursts of performance across various quarters, including this most recent one, it seems Gadani may be starting to slip off the port reports once again.

Proof? History.

Overtaken.

Last week saw four arrivals. This week, two of those were delivered, leaving just two on the port report — and no fresh arrivals. Other than the one vessel that has been idling at the waterfront for the last two weeks.

Moreover, just like its regional competition, Gadani's fundamentals — which have been among the strongest in the sub-continent ship recycling community — also saw their share of jitters. Local steel plate prices lost nearly USD 2/ton, closing the week at around USD 507/ton. The Pakistani Rupee also slipped 0.10%, ending the week at PKR 279.26.

Unstable.

Making matters worse for Gadani is not only its proximity to Iran amid the ongoing war in the region, but also the escalating tensions between the Afghan Taliban and the Pakistani government, which are now reportedly engaging in open conflict of their own, adding further instability across the region. While this may further curtail the flow of Iranian steel into Pakistan — potentially supporting local steel plate prices — the future inflow of regional tonnage into Gadani waters remains a toss-up at this time.

Overall, even though Bangladesh overtook Pakistan for the top spot on the sub-continent price board just a couple of weeks ago, the unfolding events across the Middle East, coupled with the political situation inside Pakistan — which remains unstable, with several deaths reported during pro-Khomeini rallies over the weekend — suggest that political stresses may be shifting westward. We may well see empty anchorages all over again.

Probably why the beaches in Alang will continue to remain busy.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

FIERY NEIGHBORHOOD!

Darn close.

Having close ties with the Ayatollah certainly won't help Turkey's political situation in the short term. Not only are America and Iran at odds in Turkey's front yard, but with Turkey declining U.S. use of its bases for Trump's latest catfight, the Turkish government is now expecting an influx of displaced Iranian refugees — a development that is sure to strain the state in the near term.

With the closure of the Strait of Hormuz already marginalizing supply chains for ships, Aliaga buyers are likely to get hit even harder in the short term, especially as the Lira lost another 0.32% over the last week and closed out at TRY 43.97 against the U.S. Dollar — darn close to breaking into TRY 44 next week.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 9 of 2026, GMS Market Rankings / vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Bangladesh	**Steady**	425 / LDT	445 / LDT	455 / LDT
2	Pakistan	**Steady**	420 / LDT	440 / LDT	450 / LDT
3	India	**Steady**	410 / LDT	430 / LDT	440 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Steady**	270 / LDT	280 / LDT	290 / LDT

ARE THESE NEW?

- *A cloud weighs around a million tonnes. A cloud typically has a volume of around 1km3 and a density of around 1.003kg per m3 – that's a density that's around 0.4 per cent lower than the air surrounding it (this is how they are able to float).*
- *Giraffes are 30 times more likely to get hit by lightning than people. True, there are only five well-documented fatal lightning strikes on giraffes between 1996 and 2010. But due to the population of the species being just 140,000 during this time, it makes for about 0.003 lightning deaths per thousand giraffes each year. This is 30 times the equivalent fatality rate for humans.*
- *Identical twins don't have the same fingerprints. You can't blame your crimes on your twin, after all. This is because environmental factors during development in the womb (umbilical cord length, position in the womb, and the rate of finger growth) affect your fingerprint.*
- *Earth's rotation is changing speed. It's actually slowing. This means that, on average, the length of a day increases by around 1.8 seconds per century. 600 million years ago a day lasted just 21 hours.*
- *Earlobes have no biological purpose. While they are rich in nerve endings and may play a role in social bonding, many scientists argue that earlobes don't have any true biological purpose.*
- *Your brain is constantly eating itself. This process is called phagocytosis, where cells envelop and consume smaller cells or molecules to remove them from the system. Don't worry! Phagocytosis isn't harmful, but actually helps preserve your grey matter.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
March 04 – Holi March 21 – Eid-ul-Fitr (subj. to Moon sighting) March 26 – Ram Navami March 31 – Mahavir Jayanthi	March 01 – March 07 March 18 – March 24

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
March 19 – Eid-ul-Fitr March 20 – March 23 – Jumatul Bidah + Eid Day 2 & 3 March 26 – Independence Day	March 04 – March 07 March 19 – March 22

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	**TURKEY**
March 21 – March 23 – Eid-ul-Fitr Days 1, 2, & 3	March 19 – March 23 - Eid-ul-Fitr & Ramzan Bayrami

Prices indicated above are as reported in the market and are not necessarily accurate. This information is provided without prejudice and is given in good faith and without any guarantees whatsoever. While every care has been taken in the preparation of this report, no liability can be accepted for any loss incurred in any way whatsoever by any person relying on the information contained herein. Opinions expressed herein may be deemed subjective and arbitrary. This WEEKLY is intended only for the person or entity to which it is addressed and may contain confidential and/or privileged material. Any review, retransmission, dissemination, or other use of this information by persons or entities other than the intended recipient is prohibited.

ALANG - Port Position as of February 27, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	*Armu*	*3,462*	*General Cargo*	*Delivered February 20*
2	*ASB Bonito*	*7,022*	*Bulk Carrier*	*Delivered February 19*
3	Bianca	8,987	Oil Tanker	Arrived February 26
4	*Diana*	*15,065*	*Oil Tanker*	*Delivered February 15*
5	*Dimple*	*4,869*	*Bulk Carrier*	*Delivered February 17*
6	Falo	2,067	Oil Tanker	Arrived February 24
7	Mokhia	25,536	Container	Arrived February 26
8	*Seun*	*2,296*	*Reefer*	*Delivered February 21*
9	*Sofia II*	*2,450*	*General Cargo*	*Delivered February 23*
10	*Teak*	*29,685*	*LNG Carrier*	*Delivered February 18*
11	*Valda*	*2,710*	*General Cargo*	*Delivered February 25*
Morality		**104,148**		

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of February 27, 2026

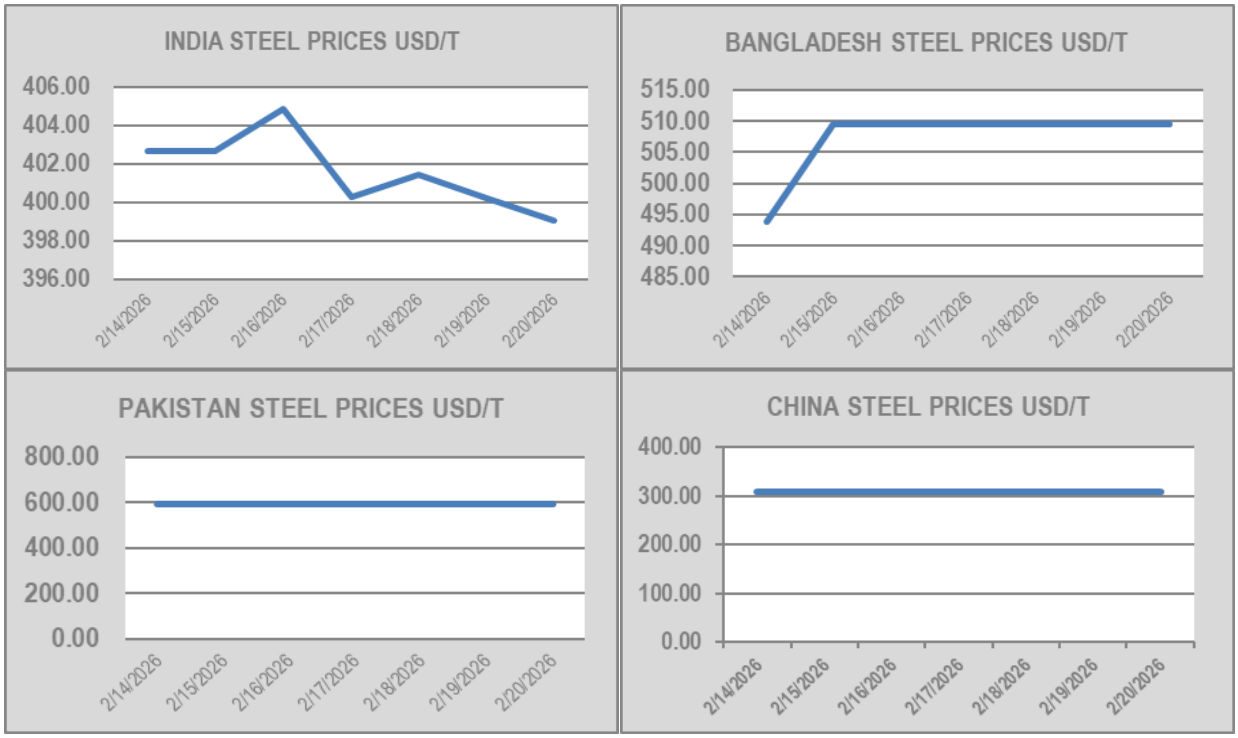
No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	*Aisha Sarwar*	*7,183*	*Bulk Carrier*	*Delivered February 23*
2	*Nila*	*26,915*	*LNG Tanker*	*Delivered February 21*
3	Sage Sagittarius	19,943	Bulk Carrier	Arrived February 26
4	Sirrah	7,072	Bulk Carrier	Arrived February 13
		61,113		

GADANI - Port Position as of February 27, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	*Rich Lucky*	*2,815*	*General Cargo*	*Delivered February 22*
2	Xing Fa	2,300	Tanker	Arrived February 16
Total Tonnage		**5,115**		

WHILE EXTREME CARE HAS BEEN TAKEN IN THE PREPARATION OF THIS REPORT, NO LIABILITY CAN BE ACCEPTED FOR ANY LOSS INCURRED IN ANY WAY WHATSOEVER BY ANY PERSON RELYING ON THE INFORMATION CONTAINED HEREIN.

DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
2/14/2026	402.69	36,500.00	594.09	167,000.00	493.84	60,100.00	308.91
2/15/2026	402.69	36,500.00	594.09	167,000.00	509.45	62,000.00	308.91
2/16/2026	404.85	36,700.00	594.09	167,000.00	509.45	62,000.00	308.91
2/17/2026	400.31	36,300.00	594.09	167,000.00	509.45	62,000.00	308.91
2/18/2026	401.41	36,400.00	594.09	167,000.00	509.45	62,000.00	308.91
2/19/2026	400.22	36,300.00	594.09	167,000.00	509.45	62,000.00	308.91
2/20/2026	399.03	36,300.00	594.09	167,000.00	509.45	62,000.00	308.91



www.gmsinc.net GMS_Leadership GMS Leadership snp@gmsinc.net

Athens, Greece Tel: +30.210.899.0669
Cumberland, USA Tel: +1.301.759.9240
Hamburg, Germany Tel: +49.40. 3197.9963
Shanghai, China Tel: +86.216.075.1900
Singapore Tel: +65.6823.8037
Bhavnagar, India Tel: +91.278.300.5253
Dubai, UAE Tel: +971.4.423.0720
New York, USA: +1.240.505.9716
Seoul, South Korea Tel: +82.10.4650.0720
Tokyo, Japan Tel: +81.3.5453.6311